

Reflection

To create my graduate program timeline, I used Python with the `python-pptx` library to programmatically generate a multi-slide PowerPoint presentation exported as a PDF. This approach met all assignment requirements: the chart spans a multi-year timeline from Spring 2026 to Fall 2029, uses color coding to distinguish transfer credits, current coursework, planned courses, and dissertation research, and marks five milestones, Preliminary Exam, Dissertation Proposal, Data Collection, Dissertation Writing, and Defense, with explicit sequencing that reflects real dependencies between phases. The chart is exportable and shareable for IDP submission.

One insight I gained by mapping this timeline is how the dissertation research credit structure shapes the entire schedule. Committing to 8 credits per semester exclusively for research from Summer 2027 onward not only satisfies the 90-credit requirement precisely, without relying on scattered low-credit registrations, but also compresses the program to Fall 2029, a full year earlier than my initial estimate. The visual map made this compression both visible and defensible.